

Credit Card Review Analysis

Google Data Analytics–Style Case Study

Consumer reviews, current issuer terms, and category recommendations

Prepared by Nagasaicharan Kasireddy

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Project Overview

This case study evaluates which cards earned the strongest consumer review scores in a public Indian credit-card review dataset, then compares the current borrowing cost, annual fee, welcome offer, rewards, and benefits of the five highest-ranked eligible cards. Review popularity and current product value are deliberately kept separate because the reviews were collected years before the issuer terms were verified.

Executive finding

There is no single universal winner. Axis Bank My Zone has the highest average numeric rating; SBI Card ELITE has the largest review volume among the top five and the strongest verified premium welcome/lifestyle package; ICICI Bank Coral has the best low-fee waiver structure; Flipkart Axis Bank has the clearest shopping-cashback proposition; and Axis Bank Horizon has the strongest travel package, but it is the current successor to the legacy Citi PremierMiles card—not the product originally reviewed.

Dataset KPI	Result	Interpretation
Review rows	7,513	All rows in the Kaggle workbook
Unique cards	59	Distinct reviewed card names
Numeric ratings	1,616	Only 21.5% of rows contain a usable rating
Eligible threshold	20 numeric ratings	Applied before a card could enter the top five
Highest eligible mean	4.70 / 5	Axis Bank My Zone, based on 20 numeric ratings

Deliverables

- An Excel workbook with the raw reviews, ranking formulas, current terms, methodology, source register, and native charts.
- This narrative report, organized around Ask, Prepare, Process, Analyze, Visualize, and Recommendations.

Ask

Business task

Identify the five strongest reviewed cards in the dataset and determine which one leads each decision category: borrowing cost, annual fee, welcome bonus, rewards, and overall benefits. The result should help a consumer narrow the field based on how they expect to use the card.

Questions answered

- Which cards have the strongest eligible review scores?
- Which of the top five is most popular by review volume?
- How do current finance charges and annual fees compare?
- Which card has the strongest welcome offer?
- Which card is best for shopping rewards, lifestyle benefits, or travel?
- What limitations prevent the ranking from being treated as a whole-market conclusion?

Five criteria used to distinguish cards

Criterion	What was compared	Why it matters
1. Consumer review strength	Average rating, rating count, Bayesian score, total reviews	Separates satisfaction from simple review volume.
2. Borrowing cost	Monthly finance charge and normalized effective annual rate	Interest can erase the value of rewards.
3. Annual fee	Ongoing fee and waiver threshold	Measures the hurdle before benefits create net value.
4. Welcome offer	Verified first-year bonus or activation value	Shows immediate value, but not long-term value.
5. Rewards and benefits	Earning structure, cashback, milestones, entertainment, lounge and travel benefits	Matches the card to the consumer's spending pattern.

Prepare

Review data source

The analysis uses the Kaggle Credit Card Reviews dataset published by Arjun N C. It contains 7,513 scraped review rows across 59 named cards, with review text, source, bank, category, date, and a rating field. The reviews originated from BankBazaar, MouthShut, and CardExpert. [Open the Kaggle dataset](#)

Current-term sources

The Kaggle file does not contain current APRs, fees, welcome bonuses, or issuer reward rules. Those fields were researched separately from official issuer pages. Current terms are therefore inputs to the comparison, not conclusions drawn from the review data.

- Axis Bank pages for My Zone, Horizon, the Citi migration, and Flipkart Axis Bank.
- ICICI Bank's official Coral product page.
- SBI Card's ELITE product page and Most Important Terms and Conditions.

Data integrity checks

- Verified 7,513 populated review rows and 59 distinct card names.
- Converted the Ratings column to a numeric measure only when a valid number was present.
- Counted 1,616 usable numeric ratings, equal to 21.5% coverage.
- Kept total review volume and numeric-rating volume as separate measures.
- Labeled Citi PremierMiles as a legacy reviewed product and Axis Horizon as its current migrated successor.

Data limitations

The reviews are self-selected, India-specific, and published no later than 2020. They should be treated as directional consumer sentiment, not a representative survey or a current whole-market ranking. Current offers may also vary by eligibility and can change after this report is published.

Process

Review ranking workflow

1. Group all rows by exact card name.
2. Calculate total review rows, number of numeric ratings, and average numeric rating for every card.
3. Require at least 20 numeric ratings before a card can qualify for the top five.
4. Calculate a Bayesian score using a 20-rating prior at the dataset-wide mean of 3.237.
5. Sort eligible cards by Bayesian score, then retain the five leaders.

Bayesian adjustment

$$\text{Weighted score} = (n \times \text{card mean} + 20 \times \text{global mean}) \div (n + 20)$$

This adjustment discourages a card with very few ratings from outranking a card supported by a larger rating base. All five leaders happen to have 20 numeric ratings, so their relative order is unchanged from their raw means, but the weighted score still makes the method consistent across all 59 cards.

Borrowing-cost normalization

The issuer pages use a monthly finance charge rather than a U.S.-style APR label. For a consistent comparison, the report shows both the published monthly rate and an effective annualized rate calculated as $(1 + \text{monthly rate})^{12} - 1$. At 3.75% per month, the normalized effective annualized rate is 55.55%. This is a comparison measure, not a personalized rate quote.

Workbook structure

- Dashboard — category winners and native Excel charts
- Card Ranking — all 59 cards with formula-driven review metrics
- Current Terms — top-five card terms and product-status notes
- Methodology — formulas, assumptions, and limitations
- Sources — full issuer and dataset URLs
- All Reviews — the source data retained for auditability

Analyze

Top five by eligible review score

Rank	Reviewed card	Total reviews	Numeric ratings	Average	Bayesian score
1	Axis Bank Myzone Credit card	75	20	4.70	3.969
2	ICICI CORAL VISA CONTACTLESS	20	20	4.53	3.881
3	SBI ELITE	124	20	4.50	3.869
4	CITIBANK PREMIERMILES	20	20	4.45	3.844
5	AXIS FLIPKART	85	20	4.43	3.831

Axis Bank My Zone ranks first by rating. SBI Card ELITE is the most reviewed of the five with 124 rows, so it is the popularity leader by review volume even though it ranks third on average rating.

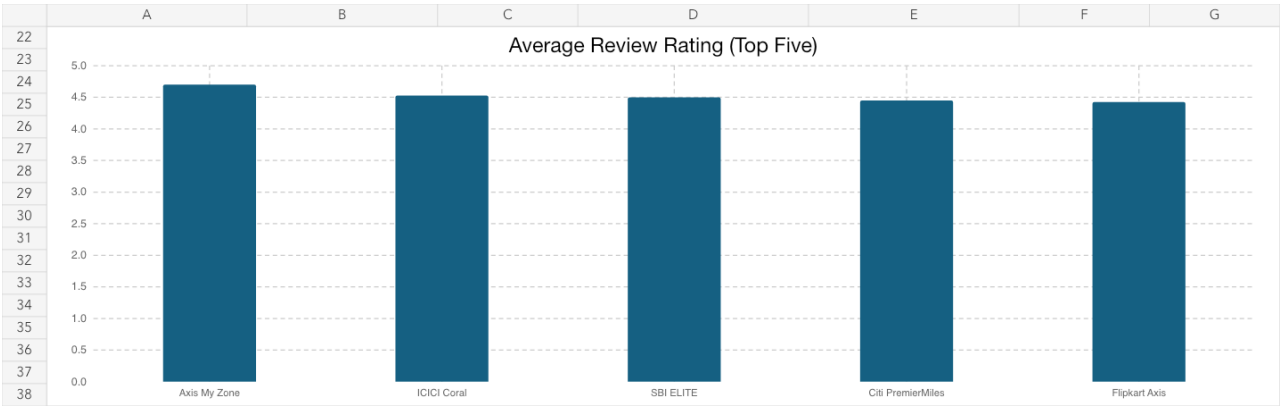


Figure 1. Average numeric rating for the five highest-ranked eligible cards.

Analyze: Current Terms

The following terms were verified from official issuer pages. Taxes, exclusions, caps, spend conditions, application eligibility, and offer periods can apply.

Current product	Monthly finance charge	Effective annualized	Annual fee	Welcome offer
Axis Bank My Zone	3.75%	55.55%	₹500	SonyLIV annual subscription valued at ₹1,499
ICICI Bank Coral	3.75%	55.55%	₹500; waived at ₹1.5 lakh	No separate welcome gift listed
SBI Card ELITE	Up to 3.75%	55.55% at 3.75% monthly	₹4,999; waived at ₹10 lakh	₹5,000 e-gift voucher
Axis Bank Horizon*	3.75%	55.55%	₹3,000	5,000 EDGE Miles after qualifying first transaction
Flipkart Axis Bank	3.75%	55.55%	₹500 from year 2; waived above ₹3.5 lakh	Current activation value starts with ₹100; up to ₹350 can depend on fee offer eligibility

** Axis Horizon is the current migrated successor to Citi PremierMiles. The review score belongs to the legacy Citi product; the listed terms belong to Horizon.*

Rewards and benefits by card

Axis Bank My Zone: 4 EDGE Reward points per ₹200 on eligible spends, plus 1,000 points at ₹1.5 lakh annual spend. Benefits include the SonyLIV welcome subscription, District buy-one-get-one movie offer, Swiggy discount, conditional domestic lounge access, and a fuel surcharge waiver. [Official source](#)

ICICI Bank Coral: 2 points per ₹100 on retail purchases and 1 point per ₹100 on utilities and insurance, with milestone points from ₹2 lakh spend. Benefits include a low fee waiver threshold, conditional lounge access, movie discounts, railway lounge access, and a fuel surcharge waiver. [Official source](#)

SBI Card ELITE: 5X reward points on dining, department stores, and grocery; two points per ₹100 on most other eligible spends; and up to 50,000 milestone points a year. Benefits include a ₹5,000 welcome voucher and movie tickets worth up to ₹6,000 a year. [Official source](#)

Axis Bank Horizon: 5 EDGE Miles per ₹100 on Travel EDGE and direct airline purchases, and 2 EDGE Miles per ₹100 on eligible other spends. Benefits include domestic and international lounge visits, a fuel surcharge waiver, and lost-card liability coverage. [Official source](#)

Flipkart Axis Bank: 7.5% cashback on Myntra, 5% on Flipkart and Cleartrip, 4% at preferred merchants, and 1% on eligible other spends, subject to caps and exclusions. Benefits include a limited-period nil joining fee and a fuel surcharge waiver. [Official source](#)

Visualize

Review score, review volume, and current financial value answer different questions. The charts below keep those measures separate so a high review rating is not confused with market popularity or a temporary welcome offer.

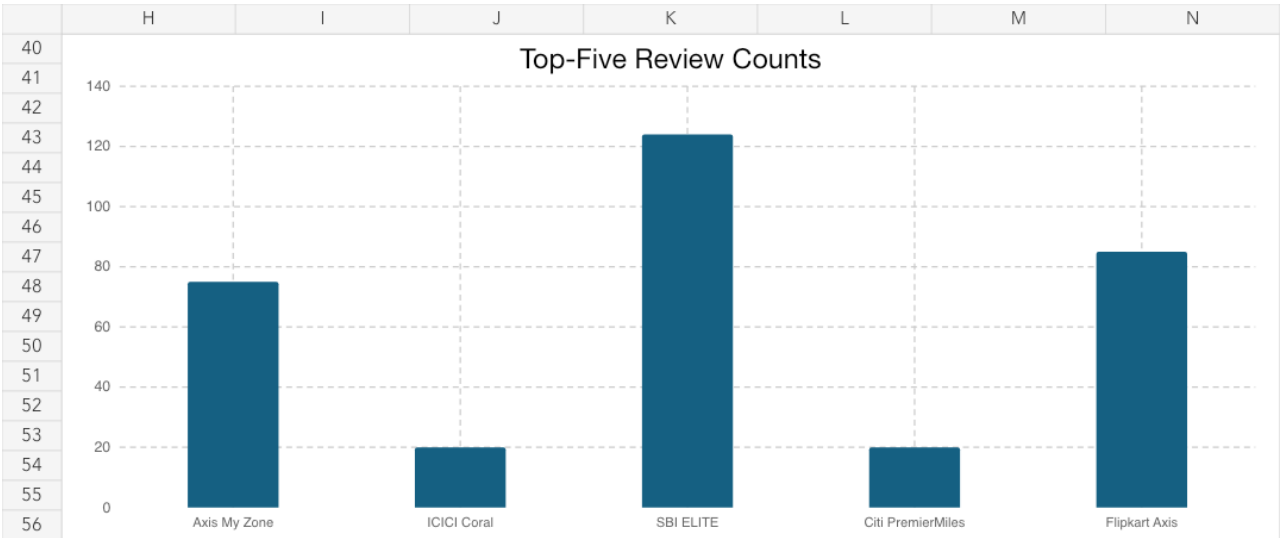


Figure 2. Review-row volume among the top five. SBI Card ELITE is the most reviewed.

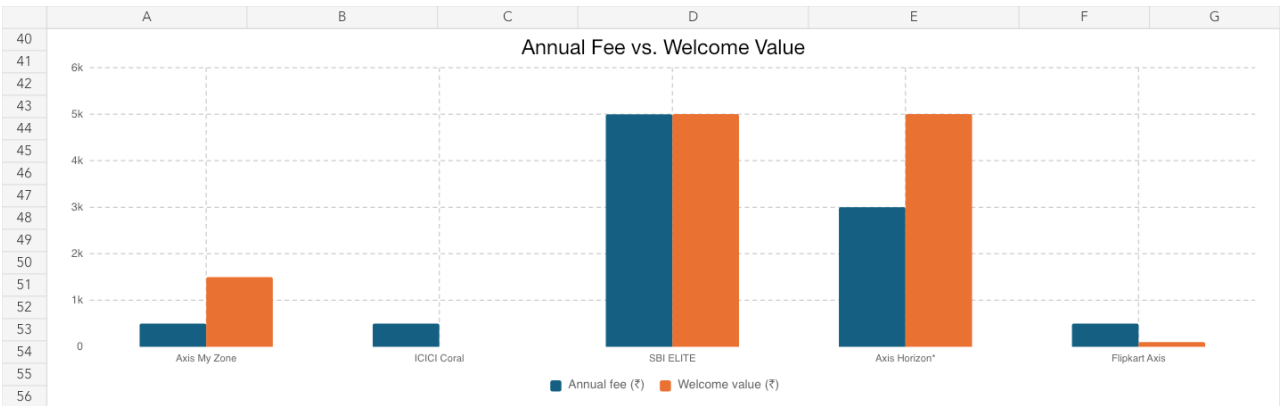


Figure 3. Annual fee compared with current welcome value. Axis Horizon is a successor product, and its bonus is denominated in EDGE Miles.

Recommendations

Category leaders

Category	Leader	Why
Highest review rating	Axis Bank My Zone	4.70 average from 20 numeric ratings
Most popular by review volume	SBI Card ELITE	124 review rows among the top five
Lowest borrowing cost	Five-way tie	Each current term page lists 3.75% monthly finance charge
Best ongoing fee / waiver	ICICI Bank Coral	₹500 annual fee with waiver at ₹1.5 lakh spend
Best welcome bonus	SBI Card ELITE	₹5,000 e-gift; Horizon also offers 5,000 miles but is a successor product
Best shopping rewards	Flipkart Axis Bank	The clearest high-rate cashback structure for major shopping partners
Broadest verified lifestyle benefits	SBI Card ELITE	Welcome voucher, movies, accelerated rewards, and milestones
Best travel package	Axis Bank Horizon	Airline/travel miles and domestic/international lounges; successor caveat applies

Best card by consumer profile

- Everyday entertainment and dining discounts: Axis Bank My Zone.
- Low ongoing cost with achievable fee waiver: ICICI Bank Coral.
- Premium welcome and lifestyle value for a high spender: SBI Card ELITE.
- Shopping-led cashback: Flipkart Axis Bank.
- Travel rewards and lounges: Axis Bank Horizon, while recognizing that its terms are not the historical Citi PremierMiles terms.

Overall recommendation

Choose based on spending pattern, not on rating alone. For a typical consumer who pays in full and wants low fixed cost, ICICI Bank Coral offers the most balanced fee structure. For shopping-heavy spending, Flipkart Axis Bank is the stronger rewards choice. For premium lifestyle value, SBI Card ELITE is the leader only when the cardholder can use enough of the benefits to justify the fee.

Most important caution: All compared current products list a 3.75% monthly finance charge. Carrying a balance can outweigh rewards and welcome benefits quickly.

Limitations and Sources

Limitations

- The review data is not a current market-share dataset and does not establish which card has the most customers.
- Only 21.5% of review rows contain numeric ratings; the top-five rating result is based on those numeric rows.
- The dataset is India-specific and self-selected, so it may overrepresent unusually positive or negative experiences.
- Citi PremierMiles is no longer compared as a current Citi product; Axis Horizon terms are presented only as the current migrated successor.
- Issuer pricing, rewards, eligibility rules, caps, taxes, and limited-period offers can change. Consumers should verify terms immediately before applying.

Primary sources

[Kaggle — Credit Card Reviews](#)

[Axis Bank — My Zone Credit Card](#)

[ICICI Bank — Coral Credit Card](#)

[SBI Card — ELITE](#)

[SBI Card — Most Important Terms and Conditions](#)

[Axis Bank — Citi migration information](#)

[Axis Bank — Horizon Credit Card](#)

[Axis Bank — Flipkart Axis Bank Credit Card](#)

Reproducibility note

The companion Excel workbook retains the full source review table and the formulas used for each card's total reviews, numeric-rating count, mean rating, Bayesian score, eligibility, and eligible rank. It also contains the current-term input table and complete source register.